



Photograph Achishek Mishra

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by Dennis E. Shasha

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TRADITIONS MEETS TECH

Pune To Have Animation Gurukul

Saurabh Gadgil, a jeweller from Pune seems to be attracted to technology, and comes up with ingenious ways to show it. First came the setting up a jewellery store in Sunnyvale for the benefit of all the Indians living in Silicon Valley. His other brilliant idea was to set up the Seamless Education Academy or SeamEdu which will continue the *guru-shishya parampara* by teaching subjects like Animation, Broadcast Journalism and gaming in a gurukul type environment.

The students will live communally, and leading experts from all around the world will be giving lectures to the students. The purpose

of such a system of education is to ensure that each student gets the highest quality of education at the individual level. The courses will be designed according to the international standards of the industry. The school will be operational from September 30, and the school has acquired two major studios in Pune.

Anand Khandekar, the chairman of the gaming and animation wing of the MCCIA (Maharatta Chamber of Commerce, Industry and Agriculture) will be one of the members on the board of the school. The school is also looking to tie up with international universities, but won't be government funded and will run as a private limited company. SeamEdu hopes to capitalise on the fast growing gaming, animation and broadcast markets in the sub-continent and hopes to enrol 2,000 students by next year. While there are no specific figures

available, the *gurudakshina* is bound to be pretty hefty.

ADAG LUNCHES BIG TV

HDTV In India By Year End?

Anil Dirubha Ambani Group's Reliance Communications launched Big TV Direct to

Home television on August 15. There are now three major players in India's DTH market: Zee's Dish TV, Tata's Tata Sky and Anil Ambani's Big TV.

By all appearances, Big TV seems to have a competitive edge, with movie quality broadcasts using the MPEG-4 technology, whereas both Tata sky and Dish TV are still using the MPEG-2 formats. While both Tata sky and Dish TV have 6

